# Yixiong Hao

yixiong_hao@outlook.com | (470)-457-3887 | Website | LinkedIn | GitHub | Google Scholar

## EDUCATION

**Georgia Institute of Technology** — Atlanta, Georgia

*Bachelor of Science in Computer Science & BSMS.* **GPA: 4.0** — *Jan 2024 – May 2027*

- **Coursework:** DSA II, OOP, Objects & Design, Systems & Networks, Linear Algebra, Calculus III, AI, Deep Learning.

## EXPERIENCE

**Grantmaker (Astra Fellow)** | Astralis Foundation — *Aug 2026 – Jan 2027*

- Grantmaker #3, focusing on AI strategy and opportunities in Asia to reduce societal scale risks from AI.

**MLE Intern** | Gray Swan AI — *May 2026 – Aug 2026*

- Self directed research on LLM robustness to Indirect Prompt Injections + strategy and collaborations work to accelerate 3rd party evaluations.

**Co-Founder and Head of Strategy** | Second Look Research — *March 2026 – Present*

- Raised $600k+ USD to replicate and open source decision relevant empirical research in AI safety.
- Co-owned organizational strategy, hiring pipeline, program design, and research management.

**Co-director, Advisor** | Georgia Tech AI Safety Initiative — *2024 – Present*

- Grew organizer headcount from 2 to 16, fellowship participants from 30 to 70+ per cohort, reached 1k+ students through events, members published 15+ papers at peer reviewed venues.
- Placed 15+ members in full time equivalent roles at key organizations including METR, MATS, Anthropic, IAPS, Constellation.

**Researcher** | UChicago XLab, PAIR Lab @ GT — *May 2024 – 2026*

- Proof of existence for a novel threat model involving **agentic misalignment in RLVR style post training** in collaboration with the Center for AI Safety.
- Leading early mechanistic interpretability work on low level actuators policies like Vision-Language-Action models.

**Quantitative Finance Research Intern** | China Industrial Securities — *Jun 2024 – Aug 2024*

- Trained the **deep momentum** strategy in the Chinese stock market, achieving a **1.80 Sharpe ratio** with a long-short portfolio in back-testing. Used TensorFlow to build a deep neural network that classified stocks into expected return deciles based on momentum factors and implemented downstream statistical processing.
- **Optimized the proposed model to ~20% the original size** with grid search and no significant loss of performance.

## SELECT PUBLICATIONS

Evaluation Cards: An Interpretive Layer for AI Evaluation Reporting — ***NeurIPS 2026 Spotlight***

A. Ghosh, A. Reuel, J. Chim, …, **Y. Hao**, …, I. Solaiman

Evaluation-Conditioned Training: Teaching Models to Generalize to Stronger Oversight Regimes — ***COLM 2026 Workshop***

A. Harris, K. Corra, A. Chaudhury, **Y. Hao**

Patterns and Mechanisms of Contrastive Activation Engineering — ***ICLR 2025 Workshop***

**Y. Hao**, A. Panda, S. Shabalin, S. A. R. Ali

Interpreting Large Text-to-Image Diffusion Models with Dictionary Learning — ***CVPR 2025 Workshop***

S. Shabalin, A. Panda, D. Kharlapenko, A. R. Ali, **Y. Hao**, A. Conmy

Shall We Play a Game? Language Models for Open-ended Wargames — ***EMNLP 2025 Workshop***

G. Matlin, P. Mahajan, I. Song, **Y. Hao**, R. Bard, …, M. Riedl

## PROJECTS

**BuzzBot – Gatech virtual advisor** — 2024

- RAG system with elastic search and tool-use to answer questions about all things Gatech.

Life-sized Quadruped robot — *2023*

- Planned, designed, and built a fully functional robot dog with 3 DoF limbs and custom 3D printed body.
- **Stack:** ESP32, Adafruit 16 channel controller, ToF sensors, C in Arduino IDE, inverse kinematics, trajectory planning.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Programming Languages & tools:** Python, C, Java, bash scripting, Git, Slurm, Docker, Claude Code, Django, Next.js, Agile, CI/CD.

**AI & ML:** PyTorch, TF, HuggingFace, NumPy, Pandas, LangChain, VeRL, reinforcement learning, evolutionary algorithms, NLP, data visualization, transformers, weights & biases.